

# Finite-Center Accountability and the Positive Route to Binary Rank

Live review note of June 20, 2026

## Abstract

Two finite-center obstruction notes show that quotient-visible operational, sector, modular, recovery, continuum, or entropy data do not by themselves reconstruct hidden finite central rank or the predicate  $q = 2$ . This short note states the matching positive criterion. For a supplied finite center  $\mathcal{Z}_F \simeq \ell^\infty(F)$ , let  $V_F = \mathcal{Z}_F/\mathcal{C}1$  be its contrast space. A declared family of probes, effects, outcome statistics, sector labels, recovery tasks, modular records, finite-alphabet laws, or direct measurements generates a readout map  $R : V_F \rightarrow W$ . The supplied data determine exactly the quotient  $V_F/\ker R$ . Hence full finite central cardinality is recoverable only when  $R$  is faithful on the physical finite-center contrast space and an admissibility or maximality premise says this represented center is the whole physical finite center. Under those premises  $q = \text{rank } R + 1$ . A binary conclusion  $q = 2$  additionally needs one accounted contrast plus a theorem or measurement identifying that contrast as the full finite center rather than a quotient of a larger hidden extension.

This is deliberately demotion-ready. In finite statistical language it is a Blackwell/sufficiency statement. In operator-algebraic language it is a Petz-style relative-to-the-supplied-channel boundary. The possible value is only the translation into black-hole/AQFT reconstruction: recovery, entropy, sector, modular, or locally covariant records force  $q$  or  $q = 2$  only after finite-center accountability has been supplied.

**Status.** This is live non-frozen review metadata. It does not modify either frozen Team 1 paper, Lean archive, public mirror manifest, or SHA-256 package. Its purpose is external classification: known theorem, false statement, missing hypothesis, too broad physically, or useful expository corollary.

## 1 Question

Positive reconstruction theorems reconstruct the object supplied to them: a represented von Neumann algebra, a locally covariant functor, a sector category, a correctable code

algebra, a channel tested by specified preparations and effects, or a Type II algebra with trace and normalization data. The finite-center obstruction is the converse question. If the displayed data have already passed through a quotient or coarse readout, what extra premise is needed before hidden finite central rank, and in particular the binary predicate  $q = 2$ , becomes reconstructible?

## 2 Finite Accountability

**Definition 1** (finite-center contrast and readout). Let  $F$  be a finite set with  $q = |F|$ , and let

$$\mathcal{Z}_F = \ell^\infty(F), \quad V_F = \mathcal{Z}_F / \mathbb{C}1.$$

Thus  $\dim V_F = q - 1$ . A finite-center readout is a linear map

$$R : V_F \longrightarrow W$$

generated by the declared observation family: normal probes, effects, outcome statistics, sector records, recovery tasks, modular records, a finite-alphabet law, or a direct measurement channel. Its null directions are

$$N_R = \ker R.$$

**Theorem 1** (finite accountability quotient). *Let  $D_R$  be any data record whose dependence on finite-center contrasts factors through the readout map  $R : V_F \rightarrow W$ . Then:*

1.  $D_R$  factors through  $V_F / N_R$ .
2. No invariant of the finite center that varies inside a coset of  $N_R$  is reconstructible from  $D_R$ .
3. The full finite central cardinality  $q$  is reconstructible from  $D_R$  only after adding both  $N_R = 0$  and an admissibility or maximality premise saying that the represented finite center is the whole physical finite center, not a quotient, null sector, gauge reduction, excluded sector, or hidden extension.
4. Under those added premises,

$$q = \dim(V_F / N_R) + 1 = \text{rank } R + 1.$$

*Proof.* If two contrasts  $v, v' \in V_F$  have the same image under  $R$ , then  $v - v' \in N_R$ . Every record built from  $R$  assigns the same value to  $v$  and  $v'$ , so it factors through  $V_F / N_R$ . Consequently any target that changes within a coset of  $N_R$  is not a function of the supplied data.

The finite commutative algebra  $\ell^\infty(F)$  has one atomic coordinate for each element of  $F$ . After constants are quotiented out, its contrast space has dimension  $q - 1$ . If  $N_R = 0$ , the readout is faithful on that contrast space, so it determines  $\dim V_F$ . If the admissibility

premise also says the represented finite center is physically exhaustive, this dimension is the physical finite-center contrast dimension, and  $q = \dim V_F + 1$ . If  $N_R \neq 0$ , or if the represented center is only a quotient or admissible subcenter of a larger hidden center, refinements inside the null or hidden directions change the unaccounted finite cardinality while preserving all  $R$ -visible data.  $\square$

**Corollary 1** (binary rank requires two inputs). *A conclusion  $q = 2$  from finite-center readout data requires both:*

$$\dim(V_F/N_R) = 1$$

*and a maximality, admissibility, direct-measurement, or finite-alphabet theorem identifying that accounted one-dimensional contrast as the full physical finite center. One accounted contrast alone proves only that the declared experiment sees a binary quotient.*

### 3 Relation to Standard Sufficiency

The theorem should be demoted if a standard source already states this exact translation. Blackwell comparison of experiments makes sufficiency relative to a declared experiment or decision problem [1, 2]. Petz sufficiency makes recovery and equality of relative entropy relative to a declared subalgebra or channel [3, 4]. Von Neumann algebra ideal theory says ultraweakly closed two-sided ideals are central-projection summands [5, 6]. None of these facts is new.

The possible finite-center contribution is the reconstruction boundary: black-hole/AQFT records determine a finite central cardinality only when their hypotheses include faithful finite-center accountability. Without that premise, quotient-visible entropy, recovery, sector, modular, or locally covariant records reconstruct the supplied quotient, not hidden cardinality.

### 4 Claim Boundary for Reviewers

| Claim                                                                                          | Status                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $R$ determines $V_F/\ker R$ .                                                                  | Elementary finite-dimensional linear algebra.                                              |
| $R$ determines full $q$ when $\ker R = 0$ and the represented center is physically exhaustive. | Positive accountability criterion.                                                         |
| One accounted central contrast implies $q = 2$ .                                               | False without maximality, admissibility, direct measurement, or a finite-alphabet theorem. |
| Blackwell/Petz sufficiency may already contain the criterion.                                  | Reviewer should identify the exact theorem if so; Team 1 should demote.                    |

|                      |            |                                                                                               |
|----------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AQFT/OAQEC           | hypotheses | Reviewer should name the hypothesis and decide whether it is present in the Team 1 statement. |
| may already supply   | maximality |                                                                                               |
| or faithful support. |            |                                                                                               |

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## 5 Reviewer Question

Is Theorem 1 merely finite Blackwell/Petz sufficiency under a different name, or does the black-hole/AQFT translation isolate a useful claim boundary? If it is standard, the desired response is the citation and the exact theorem name. If it is false or too broad, the desired response is a counterexample or missing physical hypothesis.

## References

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